

Terms of Service

Last updated: September 22, 2026

Dorm Mart is a marketplace where University at Buffalo students buy, sell, and trade with each other. These are the rules for using it. We've written them in plain English, because terms nobody reads protect nobody. If something here doesn't make sense, ask us before you agree to it.

1. Who can use Dorm Mart

Dorm Mart is for current UB students. To hold an account you need to:

- Have a working @buffalo.edu email address.
- Be 18 or older.
- Give accurate information about yourself.
- Keep one account. No duplicates, no accounts in someone else's name.

If you graduate, transfer, or otherwise stop being a UB student, your access ends. We can suspend or close accounts that don't meet these conditions.

2. What Dorm Mart is, and what it isn't

We connect UB students to each other. We host listings, search, chat, scheduling, reviews, and an optional payment step when it's switched on. That's where our role stops.

We are not:

- The seller or the buyer in your transaction.
- An escrow service holding anyone's money.
- A delivery or shipping service.
- An inspector who verifies that items are real, working, or as described.
- A guarantor that anyone shows up, pays, or hands over what they promised.

Every deal on Dorm Mart is between two students. What you agree to is yours to honor, and what goes wrong is yours to sort out. We'll help with conduct and safety. We're not a party to your deal.

3. What you can list

Fair game

- Textbooks, notes, and course materials you're allowed to resell.
- Electronics, accessories, and chargers.
- Dorm and apartment furniture.
- Clothing, shoes, and personal items.
- Kitchen gear and small appliances.

- School and office supplies.
- Bikes, scooters, and other ways to get across campus.
- Sports gear and hobby equipment.

Never allowed

- Alcohol, tobacco, vapes, controlled substances, or paraphernalia.
- Prescription medication.
- Weapons, ammunition, or explosives.
- Stolen, counterfeit, or knockoff goods.
- Food, because nobody can verify how it was stored.
- Live animals.
- Adult content or materials.
- Anything that breaks UB housing rules, such as candles, space heaters, or hot plates.
- Coursework sold to be submitted as someone else's work. That's an academic integrity violation and we'll treat it as one.
- Accounts, licenses, or subscriptions you can't legally transfer.

We take down listings that break these rules, and repeat offenders lose their accounts. If you're not sure whether something's allowed, ask a moderator before you post it.

4. Your responsibilities

When you're selling

- Describe the item honestly, including what's wrong with it.
- Use your own photos of the actual item, not stock images.
- Price it honestly. No fake markdowns from a price you invented.
- Answer messages within about 48 hours, or take the listing down.
- Show up when you said you would, with what you listed.
- Mark the item sold once it's gone, so nobody wastes a trip.

When you're buying

- Ask your questions before you agree, not after.
- Inspect the item in person before money changes hands.
- Pay what you agreed, when you agreed.
- Show up on time, or cancel early enough that the seller can re-list.
- Don't renegotiate the price at the meetup after they've already agreed to meet.

Assume the other person is a student with class in twenty minutes. Be on time, be clear, and don't waste each other's day.

5. Meeting up safely

Most of Dorm Mart happens in person. These aren't suggestions. They're the conditions that make a student marketplace workable at all.

- Meet in a public campus space: a lobby, the library, the Student Union. Not a dorm room, not a parking garage, not an off-campus address.
- Meet in daylight when you can. When you can't, pick somewhere well-lit and busy.
- Bring a friend for anything expensive.
- Tell someone where you're going and when you expect to be back.
- Count cash before you walk away, and confirm a digital payment actually landed before you hand anything over.
- If it feels wrong, leave. You don't owe anyone a transaction or an explanation.

If you're ever in danger, call 911 or UB Police first. Report the account to us afterward so we can act on it, but make the call first.

6. Messaging

- Keep first contact on Dorm Mart. It's the only record we can review if something goes wrong later.
- No harassment, slurs, threats, or discrimination. Not once, not as a joke.
- No spam, no mass messaging, no pitching unrelated businesses.
- Don't keep messaging someone who has stopped replying.
- Never ask for a password, a bank login, or anything else you don't need to complete the deal.

Chat runs through a profanity filter, and any message can be sent to a moderator with the report button. Reports are reviewed by a person.

7. Reviews and ratings

After a completed transaction you can leave a review. Reviews are most of what keeps this marketplace honest, so:

- Review the transaction you actually had, not one you heard about.
- No reviews traded for discounts, and no reviews written about yourself from a second account.
- Don't put personal details in a review: no full names, phone numbers, addresses, or schedules.
- Disagreeing with a review isn't grounds for removing it. We take down reviews that are abusive, fabricated, or unrelated to the transaction.

Your average rating is public. It's the closest thing this platform has to a reputation, and we protect it from manipulation in both directions.

8. Scheduled purchases

A seller can propose a time and place for a handoff, and the buyer accepts it. A scheduled purchase is a commitment between the two of you, not a contract with us.

- Accepting a schedule means you intend to be there.
- Cancel through the app if plans change, as early as you can manage.
- Both sides confirm the handoff in the app afterward. That's what closes the transaction and unlocks reviews.
- No-shows and last-minute cancellations can be reported. A pattern of them can cost you your account.

9. Payments and fees

Dorm Mart is free. No listing fees, no commission, no subscription.

Built-in card payments are currently switched off, so every payment happens directly between you and the other student. Cash, or a payment app you both agree on. Your call and your risk. Treat any request to pay before you've seen the item as a red flag.

If built-in payments are switched back on

- Payments are processed by Stripe and charged directly to the seller's own connected Stripe account. The money never passes through Dorm Mart, and we don't take a cut.
- The seller is the merchant of record, and owns the processing fees, refunds, chargebacks, disputes, and taxes that come with that.
- There's a fixed window to pay once the scheduled time arrives. Miss it and the purchase drops back to manual confirmation permanently.
- It isn't escrow and it isn't buyer protection. You still need to inspect the item.
- Stripe may require identity verification, and can restrict, delay, or deny accounts and payouts under its own rules. Those decisions are Stripe's, not ours.

Taxes on what you sell are yours to handle. If you're selling enough for that to matter, talk to someone who does taxes for a living.

10. Your content

- Your photos, descriptions, and messages stay yours.
- By posting them, you give us permission to display, resize, and cache them so the platform can show them to other students. That permission ends when you delete the content, aside from copies sitting in backups or attached to a moderation record.
- Don't post anything you don't have the rights to. No photos lifted from a retailer's site, no copyrighted material.
- We can remove content that breaks these terms, and we don't have to warn you first when it's serious.

11. Moderation and enforcement

If something goes wrong with another user, try to settle it with them directly first. Most problems turn out to be a misunderstanding about a meeting time. If that doesn't work, report it.

Reports go to a moderator who reviews the account, the listing, and the reported messages. Enforcement escalates roughly like this:

- First problem: a warning, or a short suspension if it was serious enough to warrant one.
- Repeat problems: a longer suspension.
- Serious problems such as threats, fraud, stolen goods, or harassment: a permanent ban, immediately.

We judge each case on what happened rather than on a rigid tally. Being new isn't a defense, and being popular isn't a shield. If you think we got a decision wrong, reply to the notice and we'll take another look.

12. Don't break the platform

- No probing for vulnerabilities, no injection attempts, no brute-forcing logins.
- No scraping listings or user data in bulk.
- No bots, automated posting, or fake accounts.
- No fake listings, fake interest, or coordinated pricing to make something look scarcer or pricier than it is.
- No using Dorm Mart as a storefront for an outside resale business. This is a student marketplace.
- No working around bans, blocks, filters, or the reporting system.

If you find a security bug, tell us instead of using it. Report it privately, don't exploit it, and don't publish it before we've fixed it. We'd rather hear it from you.

13. Leaving, suspension, and termination

You can leave anytime

- Delete your account from Settings. Your listings come down and your personal data is removed.
- Completed transaction records may be kept where the law requires it.
- Deleting your account doesn't cancel a deal you already agreed to.

We may close an account for

- Breaking these terms.
- Fraud, or activity that looks like fraud.
- No longer being a UB student.
- Two years of inactivity.

When we suspend or close an account, we'll tell you why unless there's a legal or safety reason we can't.

14. Disputes between users

A disagreement about an item, a price, or a no-show is between the two of you. We're not a court, and we don't arbitrate transactions. We can't determine who's telling the truth about a phone that stopped working a week later.

What we do handle is conduct. Harassment, fraud, stolen goods, and threats are our business, and we'll act on the accounts involved.

What you can do: report it to us, report it to UB Police if it's criminal, and leave an honest review.

15. Our relationship with UB

- Dorm Mart is student-built and student-run. It is not an official University at Buffalo service, and UB neither operates nor endorses it.
- UB's Student Code of Conduct and housing policies still apply to you, regardless of what happens here.
- We cooperate with UB administration and UB Police when there's a safety or legal reason to.
- We use the UB name to say who this is for, not to claim a partnership.

16. What we're not liable for

Dorm Mart is provided as is. We build it carefully, but we don't warrant that it's error-free, always available, or that it will meet your expectations.

We're not responsible for:

- Anything that happens between users: bad items, no-shows, disputes, injuries, or money lost.
- What users post, including listings, messages, and reviews.
- Downtime, bugs, or data loss, though we work to prevent all three.
- Decisions made by third parties such as Stripe or your email provider.

To the extent the law allows, our total liability to you for anything connected to Dorm Mart is limited to what you've paid us, which on a free platform is nothing. Some jurisdictions don't permit limits like this, and where that's true, the local law wins.

17. Changes to these terms

These terms will change as Dorm Mart does. The date at the top tells you when they last did. For significant changes we'll post a notice in the app instead of quietly swapping the page. Keep using Dorm Mart after a change and you've accepted it.

18. Getting help

Use the in-app report button for anything involving another user's behavior or safety. It goes straight to a moderator.

For account problems, technical issues, or questions about these terms, contact the team. Our details are under Settings > About Us.

If someone is in immediate danger, call 911 or UB Police first, then tell us.

By creating an account or using Dorm Mart, you're confirming that you've read these terms, you understand them, and you agree to them.